Victor H. Aguiar

Curriculum Vitae

Updated November 2026

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Contact & Identity

Email vaguiarl@sfu.ca
Website vaguiarl.github.io
LinkedIn Victor Aguiar, Ph.D.
Citizenship Ecuador; Canada
Location Greater Vancouver Area, BC, Canada
Scholar Google Scholar profile

Languages: Trilingual in English, French, and Spanish.

Current Positions

Associate Professor of Economics January 2024 - present

Simon Fraser University, Greater Vancouver Area, BC, Canada

- Research and teaching across microeconomic theory, structural econometrics, computational economics, and AI.

Profile & Philosophy

- Work across decision theory, structural econometrics, AI, and product science to build systems that learn what drives people's choices.
- Build consideration-aware algorithms and scalable substitution models for markets with millions of products and continuous experimentation.
- Bridge academic rigor with product velocity, boutique problem solving, and public science diffusion, with particular emphasis on making generative AI legible and useful.

Education

Degree	Field	Institution	Year
Ph.D.	Economics	Brown University	2017
M.A.	Economics	Brown University	2013
Master's	Economics, specialization in Development Economics (Valedictorian)	Latin American Faculty of Social Sciences (FLACSO Ecuador)	2011
Master 2	International Economics and Globalisation, specialization in Economics and International Policies	Université Pierre Mendès France	2010
Economist	Economics	Catholic University of Ecuador	2008

Dissertation: Bounded Rationality, Consumer Theory, and Revealed Preferences
Committee: Roberto Serrano, Susanne Schennach, Geoffroy de Clippel

Research

Accepted

A Rationalization of the Weak Axiom of Revealed Preference

2026

Victor H. Aguiar, Per Hjertstrand, Roberto Serrano, and Özgür Evren

Accepted at *The Review of Economics and Statistics*. Includes k-acyclicity, counterfactual existence, and an ordinal representation theorem. [paper]

Current Working Papers

The Attention Cost of Stable Matching

September 2026

Victor H. Aguiar and Dian Hong

[paper]

Tabular Foundation Models and the Unity of Economic Behaviour

August 2026

Victor H. Aguiar

A unified choice experiment and structural model spanning risk, time, loss, valuation, and social-choice domains. [paper]

GARP-EFM: Improving Foundation Models with Revealed Preference Structure

March 2026

Victor H. Aguiar and Nail Kashaev

GARP filters synthetic three-good demand histories before they adapt a forecasting model, turning revealed preference into a predictive prior. [paper]

Entangled vs. Separable Choice

July 2026

Nail Kashaev, Martin Plávala, and Victor H. Aguiar

Finite, nonparametric tests distinguish separable local responses from coordinated joint choice that can pass no-signaling checks, using CHSH inequalities in the binary case and virtual-replica restrictions more generally. [paper]

Dynamic and Stochastic Rational Behavior

April 2023

Victor H. Aguiar, Charles Gauthier, Nail Kashaev, and Martin Plávala

Dynamic random utility with changing individual preferences and stable population-level choice distributions. [paper]

Estimating High Dimensional Demand under Bounded Rationality: The ESMAX Demand System

May 2020

Victor H. Aguiar and Nickolai Riabov

High-dimensional demand estimation under bounded rationality. [paper]

Publications

A New Look at the Symmetry of the Slutsky Matrix

2025

Victor H. Aguiar and Roberto Serrano

Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics, 3(2), 289-302. [paper]

Identification and Estimation of Discrete Choice Models with Unobserved Choice Sets

2025

Victor H. Aguiar and Nail Kashaev

Journal of Business & Economic Statistics, 43(1), 204-215. [paper] [replication]

Random Utility and Limited Consideration

2023

Victor H. Aguiar, María José Boccardi, Nail Kashaev, and Jeongbin Kim

Quantitative Economics, 14(1), 71-116. Top-cited paper in the journal. [paper] [replication]

Prices, Profits, Proxies, and Production

2023

Victor H. Aguiar, Nail Kashaev, and Roy Allen

Journal of Econometrics, 235(2), 666-693. [paper]

A Random Attention and Utility Model

2022

Victor H. Aguiar and Nail Kashaev

Journal of Economic Theory, 105487. [paper]

Stochastic Revealed Preferences with Measurement Error 2021

Victor H. Aguiar and Nail Kashaev

Review of Economic Studies, 88(4), 2042-2093. [paper]

Cardinal Revealed Preference: Disentangling Transitivity and Consistent Binary Choice 2021

Victor H. Aguiar and Roberto Serrano

Journal of Mathematical Economics, 94, 102462.

Adaptive Stochastic Search 2019

Victor H. Aguiar and Mert Kimya

Journal of Mathematical Economics, 81, 74-83.

A Non-Parametric Approach to Testing the Axioms of the Shapley Value with Limited Data 2018

Victor H. Aguiar, Roland Pongou, and Jean-Baptiste Tondji

Games and Economic Behavior, 111, 41-63.

Slutsky Matrix Norms: The Size, Classification, and Comparative Statics of Bounded Rationality 2017

Victor H. Aguiar and Roberto Serrano

Journal of Economic Theory, 172, 163-201.

Satisficing and Stochastic Choice 2016

Victor H. Aguiar, María José Boccardi, and Mark Dean

Journal of Economic Theory, 166, 445-482.

Short Papers and Book Chapter

- **Random Rank-Dependent Expected Utility.** With Nail Kashaev. *Games*, 13(1):13, 2022.
- **Classifying Bounded Rationality in Limited Data Sets: A Slutsky Matrix Approach.** With Roberto Serrano. *SERIEs*, 9(4), 389-421, 2018.
- **Random Categorization and Bounded Rationality.** *Economics Letters*, 159, 46-52, 2017.
- **An Index of Unfairness.** With Roland Pongou, Roberto Serrano, and Jean-Baptiste Tondji. In *Handbook of the Shapley Value*, CRC Press, 2019.

Selected Work before the Ph.D.

- **El mercado laboral ecuatoriano, propuesta de una reforma.** Mimeo, 2007.
- **Una nueva política fiscal para el Buen Vivir.** With coauthors. Servicio de Rentas Internas Ecuador, Abya-Yala, 2012.
- **Análisis de la reforma tributaria en el Ecuador, 2001-2012.** With Luis Castro and Mayra Sánchez. CEPAL, Serie Macroeconomía del Desarrollo, 2014.

Honors, Editorial Roles & Recognition

- George Borts Prize, awarded by the Brown University Department of Economics in recognition of an outstanding Ph.D. dissertation, 2016.
- Associate Editor, *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization* (JEBO), through March 2026.
- Excellence in Refereeing, *Review of Economic Studies* (for 2023; announced 2025).
- Wiley top cited paper recognition for *Random Utility and Limited Consideration* in *Quantitative Economics*.
- Christopher J. Grimes Faculty Fellowship in Microeconomic Theory, Western University, 2021 to 2026.
- Graduate Economics Professor of the Year, Western University, 2017.

Skills & Interests

Economics and decision science: microeconomic theory; decision theory; structural econometrics; computational economics; structural microeconometrics; customer modelling; demand and substitution; causal inference; policy analysis.

AI, product science, and engineering: tabular and time-series foundation models; generative AI; machine learning; experimentation; scalable computation and data engineering; PySpark; PyTorch; Python; Julia; SQL.

Practice: boutique problem solving; public science diffusion; product strategy; technical communication; consulting across private, public, and multilateral settings.

Industry & Academic Experience

Senior Economist, Stores Economics & Science (SEAS) May 2025 - May 2026

Amazon, Seattle, WA, USA; previously Core-AI and Central Econ

- Worked at the intersection of decision theory, structural econometrics, and AI on algorithms that model consideration and scalable substitution systems.
- Built for markets with millions of products and continuous experimentation, connecting customer modelling, computation, and product decisions.

Associate Professor of Economics (with tenure) July 2021 - December 2023

Western University

Assistant Professor of Economics July 2016 - June 2021

Western University

Consulting

World Bank 2012; 2014-2016

- Technical notes and economic analysis for the Ecuador Skills Development Strategy for Social Inclusion and the Ecuador Country Economic Memorandum.
- Work on labor forces, markets, local and international migration, and economic analysis.

Government, Multilateral, and NGO Work - Ecuador and EU partnerships 2009-2012

- European Commission: income mobility and labor markets using pseudo-panel GMM; VARX business-cycle monitoring and early-warning systems.
- Ministry of Coordination of Economic Policy: advisor to the Minister; multilateral trade simulation and early-warning models with the EU mission.
- SENPLADES, GTZ, and SRI: fiscal-effort estimation, decentralization, tax-incidence analysis, and social-mobility evaluation.
- Conservation International and Ministry of Social Development: monitoring and evaluation methods for Socio Bosque and the Human Development Credit program.
- GIZ: local tax reform and efficiency/equity assessment; MIPRO-FLACSO Center for Research on SMEs: Academic Director.

Selected Presentations

Upcoming seminars and external lectures:
California Institute of Technology (Caltech), Humanities and Social Sciences: Invited Seminar, November 10, 2026 (scheduled).
FLACSO Ecuador, Doctoral Program in Development Economics: *Economics of AI*, invited course lasting two weeks, February or March 2027 (dates forthcoming).

Recent seminars: University of Maryland (2024); Purdue University (2024); University of Tokyo Microeconomic Theory Workshop (2024); Simon Fraser University; Columbia Business School; Cornell; NYU; University of Michigan; University of Toronto; University of Montreal; Arizona State University; Tilburg; Bristol-Warwick; Virginia Tech; UC Riverside.

Conferences and workshops: Econometric Society World Congress, Seoul (2025); SAET, Paris (2023); ASSA Econometric Society, San Diego (2020); BGSE Summer Forum on Stochastic Choice (2019); SAET, Naples (2019); IWABE, Brussels (2019); CIREQ Micro Theory Conference (2018); BRIC 6, Columbia (2018); Econometric Society World Congress, Montreal (2015).

Teaching & Mentoring

Simon Fraser University: International Trade; Microeconomic Theory I; Computational Methods in Economics.

Western University: Microeconomics I (Ph.D.); Mathematics for Economists (Ph.D. review); Advanced Microeconomics I; Intermediate Microeconomics; Behavioral Economics; Behavioral Economics and Revealed Preferences.

Brown University: Teaching assistant for Mathematics for First-Year Ph.D., Behavioral Economics, and Financial Institutions.

Graduate supervision and mentoring: Supervisor - Charles Gauthier. Committee and advising roles for Terrence Adam Rooney, Meghdad Rahimian, Dazhuo Wei, Hans Martinez, Wang Chong, and Wilfred Youmbi; undergraduate mentoring for Rachel Cheng and Aaron Leonard.

Refereeing & Service

Refereeing: *Econometrica*; *American Economic Review*; *Review of Economic Studies*; *Quarterly Journal of Economics*; *Journal of Political Economy*; *Journal of Economic Theory*; *American Economic Journal: Microeconomics*; *Journal of Public Economics*; *Journal of Mathematical Economics*; *Journal of Business & Economic Statistics*; *International Journal of Game Theory*; *Economics Letters*; *Canadian Journal of Economics* (Senior Advisor); and others.

Selected service: Co-Director, Economic Theory Workshop; Micro Ph.D. Comprehensive Committee; Appointments Committee; Graduate Affairs Committee; Department Representative at Convocation, Western University.